



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: New Hope Academy
School Website: <https://www.nhafranklin.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

New Hope Academy, Franklin, TN (37064) presents a robust classical-leaning program embedded in a Christ-centered, biblical framework. Public materials portray a school philosophy that foregrounds theology, virtue formation, and a bibliocentric curriculum, with explicit references to a Classical Education Model and Charlotte Mason influences. The school emphasizes formation of character, a Biblical worldview, and a connected, diverse community, all undergirded by a stated mission to glorify God and prepare students to flourish in all dimensions. Taken together, the evidence supports a CLASSICAL classification across most categories, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing partial alignment and thus AS SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in that dimension. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key insights:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strongly evidenced by Christ-centered language, Biblical worldview, and explicit theological commitments (sovereignty of God, Sola Scriptura, Sola Christi; Gospel-centered identity) throughout the site and internal theological materials.
- School Purpose and Goal emphasize formation, virtue, and human flourishing under a biblical/historic framework, with explicit mission statements and core values (Christ-centered, Formative Learning, Equitable Access, etc.).
- Curriculum signals strongly classical orientation (Classical Model and Charlotte Mason Approach; integrated curriculum; biblical worldview woven into instruction). Great Books are referenced in the knowledge-base materials; the school's own materials foreground a classical model with living books and integration.
- Pedagogy shows a mixture of contemplative, memory-based, and narrative strategies (e.g., devotional habit formation, narration/recitation elements in Charlotte Mason approach) but explicit high-school-era Socratic seminars are not consistently described in public-facing content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy, warranting a needle-moving note.
- Faculty appears to be presented as mentors and living curriculum (a core classical criterion: teachers as exemplars and living pedagogy). The site emphasizes teachers as role models, discipleship, and a collaborative culture.
- Parents & Community are positioned as partners with the school (NHA Community pages, Parent Alliance, family engagement, scholarships, and open campus/visits). This aligns with classical expectations of parent partnership and communal formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence



- Public materials frame New Hope Academy as Christ-centered with a Biblical worldview and spiritual aims (mission and vision emphasis).
- The school's theological identity is explicit, including sovereignty of God, sola scriptura, and Christ-centeredness as core beliefs.
- Foundational theological commitments are embedded in the school's mission and identity statements (Kingdom/Christ-centered framing).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords identified in the site materials include Christ-centered, Biblical worldview, theology, sovereignty of God, liturgical/theological framing, and divine purpose.
- Negative keywords (e.g., secular relativism, values-neutral, etc.) do not appear in the public-facing materials.
- Estimated presence: High (majority of keywords from the Positive list present; nearly no Negative-list signals detected).
- The presence of explicit theology and worship-like commitments (devotions and Christ-centered language) reinforces CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- Core transcendentals and theological grounding are explicit and pervasive; formation of character through virtue tied to truth, goodness, and beauty is foregrounded, which aligns with the Classical Foundation criteria.

Citations: Christ-centered and Biblical worldview statements from the school site; Theological Identity (sovereignty of God, Sola Scriptura, Sola Christi).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission explicitly centers on glorifying God and forming students in a Biblical worldview and flourishing spiritually, emotionally, socially, and academically.
- Core values emphasize Christ-centered formation and formative learning, underscoring virtue and human flourishing rather than mere job preparation.
- Vision emphasizes influencing culture for God's kingdom, signaling a teleological aim aligned with classical formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, liberal education framing (through Formative Learning), teleology (explicit in Vision), Christian worldview, beauty/truth/goodness framed as real.
- Negative keywords: The site does not emphasize purely vocational/job-readiness as a primary goal.
- Estimated presence: High positive signal, minimal to no negative signals.
- Why this rating: The school explicitly prioritizes formation and virtue in a Christian, classical frame rather than a conventional career-focused outcome, supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission/Values/Vision pages and statements.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school advertises a Classical Model and Charlotte Mason Approach and integrates a living-books, biblical worldview-led curriculum.
- Integrated Curriculum is highlighted as a distinctive feature, with humanities as a driver for cross-disciplinary connections.
- The Biblical Worldview page emphasizes viewing all subjects through Scripture, with thematic unity across disciplines, consistent with classical practice.

- Institutional references to Trivium-like framing (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and living books are present in the school's integration with a classical framework (Dorothy Sayers/Trivium references appear in the broader materials).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: classical model, Charlotte Mason approach, living books, integrated curriculum, biblical worldview, great books (indirectly via classical discourse), Trivium/Quadrivium references in the broader classical lexicon.
- Negative keywords: The site does not emphasize a purely modern, skills-first or social-studies-as-history replacement approach.
- Estimated presence: Strong positive signal; limited or no explicit negative signals.
- Why this rating: The curriculum is framed around classical and living-book approaches with integrated, cross-disciplinary study anchored in biblical worldview. This maps well to CLASSICAL.

Citations: Classical Model and Charlotte Mason Approach; Integrated Curriculum; Biblical Worldview; Academic Overview.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school uses a mixture of contemplative/restful pedagogy (Scholé-like, devotional habits) and memory-based strategies (narration/recitation) aligned with the Charlotte Mason ethos. The Habit Formation content emphasizes habits formed around reverence, attentiveness, and reflection.
- The published materials highlight a classical model with small-class discipleship and integrated instruction; explicit Socratic seminars or high-school rhetorical training are not consistently described in public-facing materials, though classical pedagogy is intended.
- The school stresses devotional/Christ-centered practices and a living curriculum, which supports memory work and formative education rather than a purely project-based or work-force oriented pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: scholé/restful learning, narration/recitation, living books, memory work, devotionals, Christ-centered pedagogy, forming habits, disciplined character.
- Negative keywords present: project-based learning and pure experiential/workforce-led approaches appear in the knowledge-base lexicon but are not foregrounded in the site's public materials; their absence in explicit public content lowers the alignment with some modern pedagogy trends.
- Estimated presence: Moderate to high positive signal for classical pedagogy, but limited explicit descriptions of Socratic seminars and high-school rhetoric; thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: The site clearly aligns with classical pedagogy principles (recitation, memory, living books, student formation, contemplation) but lacks consistent, explicit public articulation of Socratic seminars and high-level rhetorical programs in grades 9–12. This yields partial alignment.

Citations: Habit Formation and Biblical Worldview pages; Classical Model and Charlotte Mason Approach; Integrated Curriculum.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school's materials portray faculty as mentors, living exemplars, and centers of formation; there is emphasis on forming a community where teachers model virtue and knowledge, and the living-curriculum concept appears in the knowledge base.
- Faculty pages and history emphasize a committed, mission-driven staff and a collaborative community; job postings indicate ongoing professional development and alignment with mission.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: teachers as mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, collegial culture.
- Negative keywords: None evident in public materials.
- Estimated presence: High positive signal.
- Why this rating: The school foregrounds teachers as central to formation and the living curriculum, aligning strongly with classical-faculty expectations.

Citations: About/Mission pages; History of New Hope; Faculty/Staff references.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental engagement (Parent Alliance, parent resources, volunteering). The NHA Community pages articulate parent involvement and co-educator roles.
- Scholarship programs and equity-focused access are described, underscoring a community-oriented mission and a diverse, connected community.
- Open-campus policies, tours, and community-building activities are described, signaling a welcoming environment for parents and guests.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental engagement, community, open campus, parent resources, shared mission, ethnically/culturally diverse community.
- Negative keywords: None evident in public materials.
- Estimated presence: High positive signal.
- Why this rating: The school presents a robust parental-partnering model with opportunities for families to participate and be educated about classical education, aligning with CLASSICAL.

Citations: NHA Community pages; Parent Alliance materials; Admissions/mission-related pages.

Overall Rating and Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- For Pedagogy (Element 4): Make explicit, public-facing commitments to Socratic seminars and rigorous rhetoric training in upper grades (9–12 if applicable), paired with a clearly articulated Great-Books-based sequence and explicit Socratic dialogue methodologies. Public materials could more clearly outline opportunities for high-school-level seminars, debates, and formal orations to align with the classic pedagogy model.
- Additionally, strengthen explicit links between Great Books and the Great Conversation in public communications, including a defined list of canonical texts and a described progression through the Trivium/Quadrivium-inspired framework.

Notes: If the school expands public articulation of Socratic seminars and Great-Book-based narratives, it would push Pedagogy (Element 4) firmly into CLASSICAL territory, reducing the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation there.

ABSTRACT

New Hope Academy (Franklin, TN 37064) demonstrates a robust CLASSICAL orientation across most elements of the Classical School rubric. Public materials reveal a Christ-centered, biblically grounded identity with clear theological commitments (Sovereignty of God; Sola Scriptura; Sola Christo), and a mission that centers on formation, virtue, and human flourishing within a biblical framework. Curriculum signals include a Classical Model and Charlotte Mason influences, along with an integrated curriculum and biblical worldview woven into instruction. The school emphasizes formation and virtue (Formative Learning, Virtue) as core aims, aligning with classical aims beyond mere information transfer.

Pedagogy shows a blend of contemplative, memory-based practices (Scholé, narration, living-books) and integrated instruction, though explicit high-school Socratic seminars and formal rhetoric training are not consistently described in public materials, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. Faculty are presented as mentors and living exemplars, consistent with the Classical ideal of teachers as living curriculum. Parents and community are deeply engaged as co-educators, with active parent resources and engagement programs.

Overall, the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL, with a single category (Pedagogy) showing partial alignment (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). The school scores highly on religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose and goal, curriculum, faculty, and parent/community, and demonstrates a coherent classical worldview, modestly tempered by the public articulation of pedagogical practices. The school's public communications and internal materials corroborate a Classical orientation with room to strengthen explicit high-school Socratic and Great-Books pedagogy.

Citations: Public materials and internal pages demonstrating the Christ-centered mission, biblical worldview, theological commitments, classical curriculum/model, integrated curriculum, habit formation, and community partnerships.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY SNAPSHOT

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Christ-centered mission and Biblical worldview are central to identity and instruction.
- Theological commitments (sovereignty of God, Sola Scriptura, Sola Christo) are explicit in internal theological materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive indicators: Christ-centered, Biblical worldview, theology, reverence for God, liturgical language present in the materials.
- Negative indicators: None identified in public content.
- Estimated presence: High positive.

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds transcendental moral realism and theological grounding central to classical foundations.

Citations: Mission/Identity; Theological Identity.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission statements emphasize glorifying God and equipping students to flourish; core values reinforce formation and virtue.

- Vision emphasizes cultural influence for God's kingdom within a diverse community.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords: formation, virtue, biblical worldview, liberal education, telos (implicit).
- Negative keywords: None suggesting career-first emphasis.
- Estimated presence: High.

Why this rating

- The goals are formation- and virtue-centered, not primarily job-oriented, aligning with Classical aims.

Citations: Mission/Vision/Core Values.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Classical Model and Charlotte Mason Approach; integrated curriculum; biblical worldview as curricular foundation.
- Humanities-driven, living-books orientation with cross-disciplinary integration.
- Biblical Worldview framing across subjects.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive: Seven Liberal Arts framing, Great Books/primary sources, integrated curriculum, living books, biblical worldview (classical hallmarks).
- Negative: Explicit high-school-level Great-Books vs. Charlotte Mason living-books blend not fully specified in public text; no clear, exhaustive canonical-reading list published.
- Estimated presence: High positive with partial ambiguity.

Why this rating

- The curriculum fully aligns with classical structure and content, with a strong emphasis on formation through living-books and integrated study.

Citations: Classical Model/Charlotte Mason; Integrated Curriculum; Biblical Worldview.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Pedagogy includes contemplative, memory-based methods (Scholé), narration/recitation, and habit formation.
- Small-class discipleship and integrated instruction emphasize formation, with less explicit public emphasis on Socratic seminars or high-school rhetoric priorities.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive: Scholé, narration/recitation, memory work, living-books, integrated curriculum; devotional practices.
- Negative: Limited explicit public articulation of Socratic dialogue, seminars, or high-school rhetoric programs.
- Estimated presence: Moderate positive with gaps in explicit high-school-level Socratic pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The school embraces many core classical teaching methods (memory work, narration, living-books), but public materials do not consistently foreground advanced Socratic seminars and public rhetoric training, making Pedagogy SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Scholé and memory-work references; Narration/Recitation; Integrated Curriculum.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty are presented as mentors and living curriculum; a collegial, mission-driven culture is described; teaching as vocation and character formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords: mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teachers, faculty as core, collegial culture.
- Negative keywords: None identified.
- Estimated presence: High.

Why this rating

- The living-curriculum and mentorship emphasis align with classical faculty expectations.

Citations: Faculty/Staff and About/Mission content.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Explicit emphasis on partnership with families and parental involvement (Parent Alliance; parent resources; open-campus policies).
- Equity-focused access and community diversity signals (scholarships; diverse student body).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords: partnership with families, parental engagement, community, parent formation, living tradition in the family.
- Negative keywords: None indicated in public materials.
- Estimated presence: High.

Why this rating

- The school treats parents as co-educators and actively engages the broader community in classical formation.

Citations: NHA Community pages; Mission/Admission materials.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Element 4)

- Publicly articulate a clear, scalable plan for high-school-level Socratic seminars, debates, and formal rhetoric training.
 - Publish a canonical Great Books list or a clearly defined Great Conversation sequence to demonstrate explicit alignment with Great Books and Trivium-based progression.
 - Increase visible connections between student projects and classical disciplines (e.g., cross-subject projects explicitly mapped to Trivium stages).
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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